

The Hypocrisy of Marriage

SEXUAL FIDELITY REQUIRES EFFORT. MAN'S BASIC INSTINCT IS TO HAVE MULTIPLE PARTNERS AND SINGULAR TIES ARE A RECENT PHENOMENON.

Chastity is the most unnatural of all sexual perversions." Aldous Huxley, who wrote this, wouldn't have been surprised by any such survey. Indeed, had monogamy been natural, restrictions imposed by marriage wouldn't have been required. Animal behaviour is governed by biological needs and multiple sexual partners create genetic variation essential for evolution. Even in the oft-quoted monogamous birds, recent DNA studies reveal that the male is often not the father and re-pairing occurs to improve reproductive choices. Human beings are no different biologically.

People changed partners liberally in nomadic communities and paternity wasn't known. As man settled, he wanted to ensure the children he was bringing up and who'd inherit his possessions, were his own. Marriage was conceived to ensure fatherhood. Polygamy and polyandry was common throughout history and one man-one woman relationships are a recent phenomenon.

Marriage demands abstinence from extra marital sex for either spouse, but the desire is so strong that marriage vows are often broken. Like all moral codes, marriage rules are generally hypocritical. Moral wrong doing, sexual

infections or unwanted pregnancies may be the reasons for some, but the fear of breaking a marriage by betrayal is the most common deterrent. Like most things pleasurable but forbidden, extra marital sex is sought when one is sure that one will not be caught.

P.G. Wodehouse once wrote that, "Fascination

people often pursue extra-marital sex for variety. Most people enter matrimony expecting much, but soon they develop a relationship which is peculiar for each couple and changes as life goes on. As people grow up, attitudes towards sex change. For example an overworked young mother may behave differently once

Traditionally it occurred in conservative families inside and around the house. Flirtation amongst relationships like brothers/sisters-in-law also has a fair bit of social sanction, and numerous folk songs centre around this. Besides consensual sex, sexual exploitation also occurs inside the family, in all societies.

A broad generalisation in the sexual behaviour of men and women also is an over-simplification of a complex relationship. The statistics from such surveys should therefore be interpreted carefully keeping social and biological differences in mind. But essentially all human beings are similar and as Carl Jung wrote, "Men and women have more in common between each other than there are differences".



26% OF THOSE WHO HAD LOVE MARRIAGES ADMITTED HAVING EXTRA MARITAL AFFAIRS

with shooting as a sport depends almost wholly upon whether you are at the right or the wrong end of the gun." Similarly, in adultery the cheating spouse generally claims that to betray you must first belong, and so there is no infidelity when there has been no love. In fact they often play the victim of a loveless marriage. While sex may sometimes be sought due to an unfulfilled need within marriage,

she is a mature woman with grown-up children. There is social as well as biological change and sexual attitudes transform with time. In fact most people first venture outside marriage at a later age, as a middle-age phenomenon.

There may be more opportunities these days to do so with mobile phones, Internet and intermixing of sexes at workplace, but extra marital sex is not new.

This is certainly not to say that sexual fidelity is impossible or wrong because it is not natural, only that it takes some effort. In fact besides the moral reason to stay faithful, there are prizes for fidelity, and people who stay in long-term monogamous relationships tend to be very healthy mentally.

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